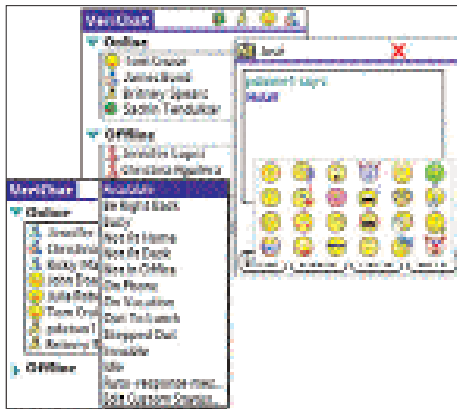


Messaging

Almost all Palm handhelds come with a functional Infra-red port; most high-end models support Bluetooth and Wi-Fi as well. This makes for great communication possibilities—be it using a handheld for typing SMS messages, or for chatting with friends over the Internet.

FunSMS supports a variety of phones and networks, with which one can send SMSes to multiple recipients. One can add signatures, use templates and request status reports. By categorising incoming messages and exporting them to Memo Pad,



VeriChat is a unified instant messaging application that works with Yahoo!, ICQ, MSN and AOL chat networks

one can also manage SMSes. Pixier MMS can create multimedia messages (MMS) using your handheld.

Chatting is ably handled by VeriChat, which allows syncing between users of the ICQ, MSN, Yahoo! and AOL messenger services. The service can forward instant messages to your

mobile phone when you are not connected to a network.

ICQ has a Palm version that shares many of the features of the desktop version. If you have a server-side contact list on your Windows desktop, ICQ mirrors your contacts to the handheld as well.

While a native version of MSN Messenger is not available for the Palm platform, MSN Messenger Force can send messages to users; it can also check your Hotmail account for e-mails.

Multimedia

Palm handhelds are now powerful enough to handle multimedia services, ranging from listening to music to watching movies. Most media has to be stored externally on an SD or MMC card.

RealOne has a Palm version of its software. This can convert your current files and port them to the handheld. It offers decent options and is freely available; it is, however, upstaged by AeroPlayer and Pocket Tunes. Both are commercial products that offer MP3 and Ogg Vorbis playback, skins, DSP plugins, advanced playlist facilities, the ability to control playback from another program, and more.

For movie playback, the Kinoma Player delivers full screen, high resolution video and is compatible with Palm OS 3.1 and later. Supporting playback from SD and MMC external memory, the software also supports video, VR objects, VR panoramas, animation and still images with synchronized audio. Its companion application, Kinoma Producer, can encode almost all popular formats into the format supported by the player.



Personal Information Managers

Agendus: <http://www.iambic.com/agendus/palmos/>

Agendus for Windows: <http://www.iambic.com/agendus/win/>

DateBk5: <http://www.pimlicosoftware.com/datebk5.htm>

HappyDays:

<http://www.palmgear.com/software/showsoftware.cfm?prodID=6289>

Diddlebug:

<http://www.palmgear.com/software/showsoftware.cfm?prodID=16870>

BugMe!:

<http://www.palmgear.com/software/showsoftware.cfm?prodID=839>

Password Managers

SplashID: www.splashdata.com/splashid

SecureIt: www.schau.com/sit/index.html

Databases

HandDBase: www.ddhsoftware.com/handbase_palm.html

MobileDB: www.handmark.com/products/mobiledb/

Office suites

Documents to Go: www.documentstogo.com

Quickoffice: www.cesinc.com/quickoffice/

wordsmith: www.bluenomad.com/ws/prod_wordsmith_details.html

Messaging

FunSMS: www.fun4palm.de/english/funsms_info.htm

Pixier MMS:

http://electricpocket.com/products/pixiermms_palm.html

VeriChat: www.pdaapps.com/verichat/

ICQ: www.icq.com/download/installpalm.html

MSN Messenger Force:

www.ruksun.com/mobile_computing/palm/Products/msn_messenger-force/

Multimedia

Pocket Tunes: www.pocket-tunes.com

AeroPlayer: www.aerodrome.us

RealOne: www.real.com/realonemobile

Kinoma Player: www.kinoma.com

Must haves

iSilo (www.isilo.com): Essentially a document viewer, iSilo can read native as well as Palm DOC files. It can additionally be used for offline browsing. Those looking for a free equivalent should consider Plucker (www.plkr.org).

TomeRaider (www.tomerader.com): Most e-books meant for handhelds are in the TomeRaider format. This range covers everything from the classics to erotica. Find thesauri, dictionaries, and encyclopaedias available for this program at www.memoware.com.

Games (www.astraware.com): There's a large library of games for Palm handhelds. Recommended amongst them are *Bejewelled*, *Glinx*, *Mummy Maze*, *GTS Racing Challenge*, *Zap!2000*, *Insaniquarium*, and *Ricochet*.

Recommended sites: FreewarePalm (www.freewarepalm.com) is a repository of freeware titles for the Palm platform. Handango (www.handango.com) and PalmGear (www.palmgear.com) are the sites to visit for the latest and greatest in Palm powered software. Memoware (www.memoware.com) and PDABooks.org (www.pdabooks.org) are for e-books.